

programs, which would enable her to work. Another option was to continue her schooling at night and get her high school equivalency diploma. With a diploma, Nora could get a better job. Finally, a case could be started with the District Attorney's office to try and collect the child support owed her.

For one reason or another, Nora turned down every option. In exasperation, the counselor finally asked how she intended to make her financial situation better. Nora told her about an inheritance that she would collect after her grandmother died. This inheritance would solve all her financial worries. The counselor asked about her grandmother's health. Nora replied, "Great." The counselor then asked how old her grandmother was? She replied, "Sixty-three." The counselor thought to herself, "Either Nora's going to be waiting a long time or she's planning something I don't want to know about!"

Like Veronique, Nora was also looking for someone else to save her. In her case, it was her grandmother. Considering her grandmother's health and age, it was not likely that Nora would be receiving any inheritance soon. A better solution would have been for Nora to attempt to collect child support. This income could have significantly improved her situation. Many women don't try to collect support that is due to them. Consequently, their financial situation suffers as they try and support a child on their own. If they are young and haven't finished school, the financial demands are almost impossible to meet.

The Boss and the Mechanic

The question of what you do for a living usually surfaces within the first few minutes of meeting someone new. When I told people I worked for Consumer Credit Counseling Service, I was always amazed that they then proceeded to share with me the most intimate details of their financial lives. In fact, it was rare when I met someone who didn't have a problem. I started to

